

Chapter 3

Worksheet

Instructions:

Please complete all activities in this worksheet. Write your answers in the spaces provided or on separate sheets if needed.

Worksheet for Chapter 3: Communication Skills for Self-Advocacy

This worksheet is designed to help you apply the concepts from Chapter 3 of the **Self-Advocacy & Confidence Building for Teens** course. You'll get to practice and reflect on Effective Verbal Communication, Non-Verbal Communication, and Active Listening Skills. Complete each section by writing down your thoughts, trying out activities, and setting goals to improve your communication for self-advocacy. Let's get started and build those skills!

Part 1: Effective Verbal Communication

Goal: Practice expressing yourself clearly and assertively to advocate for your needs.

- **"I" Statement Practice** Think of a recent situation where you felt frustrated or needed something from someone (like a friend, teacher, or family member). Write an "I" statement to express how you felt and what you needed. Use the format: "I feel [emotion] when [situation], and I need/would like [solution]."
 - Example: "I feel stressed when I'm doing most of the group project, and I'd like us to split the tasks evenly."
 - Your Turn:
- **Assertive Speaking Scenario** Imagine you're asking a teacher for extra help after class, but you're worried they might say no. Write a short script (2-3 sentences) of how you'd ask assertively—not passively or aggressively. Focus on a confident tone and clear request.
 - Your Script:
- **Reflection Question** What's one situation this week where you can use an "I" statement or assertive speaking to stand up for yourself? How do you think it will help?
 - Answer:

Part 2: Non-Verbal Communication

Goal: Build awareness of your body language and tone to project confidence.

- **Body Language Self-Check** Over the next day or two, notice your posture, eye contact, and gestures during conversations. Do you slouch, avoid eye contact, or fidget? Write down one non-verbal habit you'd like to improve and how you'll work on it.
 - Habit to Improve:
 - How I'll Work on It:
- **Confidence Pose Activity** Try a "power pose" before a big moment (like a presentation or tough convo). Stand tall, shoulders back, hands on hips, and chin up for 1-2 minutes. How does it make you feel? Write a

quick note about the difference in your confidence level.

- My Experience:
- **Reflection Question** How do you think improving your non-verbal communication (like posture or tone) can help others take you more seriously when you advocate for yourself?
 - Answer:

Part 3: Active Listening Skills

Goal: Strengthen your ability to listen and connect with others to build trust.

- **Listening Practice Log** Pick one conversation this week to practice active listening. Focus on not interrupting, nodding to show you're engaged, and summarizing what the other person said (e.g., "So, you're saying..."). After the convo, write down what you did well and what was challenging.
 - What I Did Well:
 - What Was Challenging:
- **Empathy Exercise** Think of a time someone shared a problem with you (like a friend being upset). How could you show empathy next time by imagining their feelings and responding with care? Write a short response you'd say to show you understand.
 - Empathetic Response:
- **Reflection Question** Why is active listening important when you're trying to advocate for yourself? How can it help in tough conversations with teachers, parents, or friends?
 - Answer:

Part 4: Communication Action Plan

Goal: Set personal goals to keep improving your communication skills for self-advocacy.

- **Skill Focus** Pick one skill from each section (Verbal, Non-Verbal, Listening) that you want to focus on over the next week. Write them down.
 - Verbal Skill:
 - Non-Verbal Skill:
 - Listening Skill:
- **Real-Life Application** For each skill, write down a specific situation where you'll practice it. For example, "I'll use an 'I' statement when talking to my sibling about sharing chores."
 - Verbal Situation:
 - Non-Verbal Situation:
 - Listening Situation:
- **Progress Check** At the end of the week, come back to this worksheet and jot down how it went. Did you feel more confident advocating for yourself? What worked or didn't?
 - Notes:

Bonus Fun Challenge: Communication Quest

Try out your skills in a mini "quest"! Over the next few days, complete these three mini-tasks and check them off:

- Use an "I" statement in a real conversation.
- Practice confident posture or eye contact during a class discussion or chat.
- Actively listen to someone by summarizing their point and asking a follow-up question. After completing all three, write one sentence about how it felt to be a "communication hero"!

- My Hero Moment:

Final Note: Communication is a superpower for self-advocacy, and it gets stronger with practice. Keep this worksheet handy to track your progress, and don't be afraid to try new things—even small steps make a big difference. You've got this!